ASCEND RUSH

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

2025

Genre: Speedrun / Parkour Platform: PC Engine: Unreal Engine

Play as Nyss, break the chains of The Hand, and free History.

I. TITLE

ASCEND RUSH

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III. PROJECT OVERVIEW

Field	Details
Genre	Speedrun / Parkour
Players	1 player (solo only)
Platform	PC
Engine	Unreal Engine
Target Audience	Speedrun fans, players who enjoy challenges and optimization
PEGI	7+
Universe	Science-fiction / Alternate world
Language	French

Pitch

Ascend Rush is a frantic speedrun game where speed is the key to victory. Play as Nyss, a former agent of The Hand turned renegade, and perform acrobatic feats to build up momentum. In a world where every second counts, collect Chrono-Ore fragments and free the world from the grip of The Hand.

IV. GENERAL PRINCIPLES

USP - Unique Selling Point

Build incredible speed by chaining acrobatics across a hostile planet of fire and ice.

KSP - Key Selling Points

- Test, fail, retry, and perfect your route until you find the optimal line.
- Perform aerial combos, dashes, slides, and vaults to gain speed and push the limits of gravity.
- Each level is a speed puzzle: the player must find the optimal trajectory.
- The score is diegetic: the color of the Chrono-Ore in hand indicates performance in real time.

Design Intent

Sense of Speed

The game must constantly give the player the feeling of controlling something explosive. Every successful action reinforces fluidity and perceived speed. Dynamic FOV and motion blur contribute to this immersion.

Low Skill Floor, Very High Skill Ceiling

A novice player can complete levels by walking. An expert player chains dashes, slides, and wall-runs to break records. Depth comes from optimization, not raw difficulty.

Fast Retry Loop

Death or failure should never be frustrating. Restart is instant (R key) and the player immediately resumes where they went wrong.

References

Reference Game	Borrowed Element
Mirror's Edge	Fluid first-person traversal, path readability
Ghostrunner	Extreme speed, fast die & retry, wall-run
Titanfall 2	Movement chaining, satisfying parkour
Celeste	Progressive mastery, encouraged retry, precise level design

V. MOCKUP

The mockup below (version of 12/02/2025) illustrates the first-person view. Nyss's hands are visible at the bottom of the screen, holding the Chrono-Ore. The diegetic timer appears in the top right, colored according to elapsed time.

[Mockup dated 12/02/2025 - FPS view with hands, artifact, and timer]

Notable points not yet in the mockup but required:

- First-person camera with slight oscillation during running (head bobbing).
- The Chrono-Ore must be visible in hand; its luminous intensity decreases over time.
- Minimalist interface: only the diegetic timer is displayed, no complex HUD.
- Environmental architecture: white columns, monumental staircases, cold and clean atmosphere.

VI. STORY / UNIVERSE

Synopsis

For centuries, The Hand (a political and military organization) has controlled peoples and the flow of time. Using a rare mineral called Chrono-Ore, they shape and write History to their advantage. Each fragment of this mineral holds traces of historical truth. The Hand uses it to erase, modify, and falsify past events.

Nyss, a former agent of The Hand turned renegade, discovers the true power of these stones. The Chrono-Ore does not just manipulate time: it can also restore it. She decides to steal these fragments to break The Hand's grip on History.

But the mission is not without risks. The Time Guardians constantly hunt our heroine. Every mistake can cost her her life. However, she possesses a formidable asset: Temporal Inversion. By activating a stolen fragment, she can rewind the timeline and optimize her run.

Each recovered fragment injects a piece of truth into the timeline. Each theft shakes the lie of The Hand a little more.

Character: Nyss

Attribute	Details
Name	Nyss
Age	Between 25 and 30 (assumed)
Status	Former agent of The Hand / Enemy #1 of The Hand
Origin	Luulla, a world erased from History
Personality	Determined, defiant, instinctive, perseverant
Movement	On foot with total agility and adaptability
Abilities	Superhuman speed, above-average strength, breaks walls on impact

Physical Description

Nyss is built for speed and endurance. Her body was forged by her people's genes and years of survival in hostile terrain. Her appearance reflects an extreme lifestyle and an erased past. She wears no heavy armor; every gram counts when fleeing at full speed or clearing obstacles.

Personal History

Nyss was born on Luulla, once the cradle of a superior civilization. Its inhabitants were faster, stronger, and more resilient. Hungry for knowledge, these people represented a threat to The

Hand, who eventually erased Luulla from all records. The last survivor of her people, Nyss wages a solitary war against the organization.

Destruction Technique

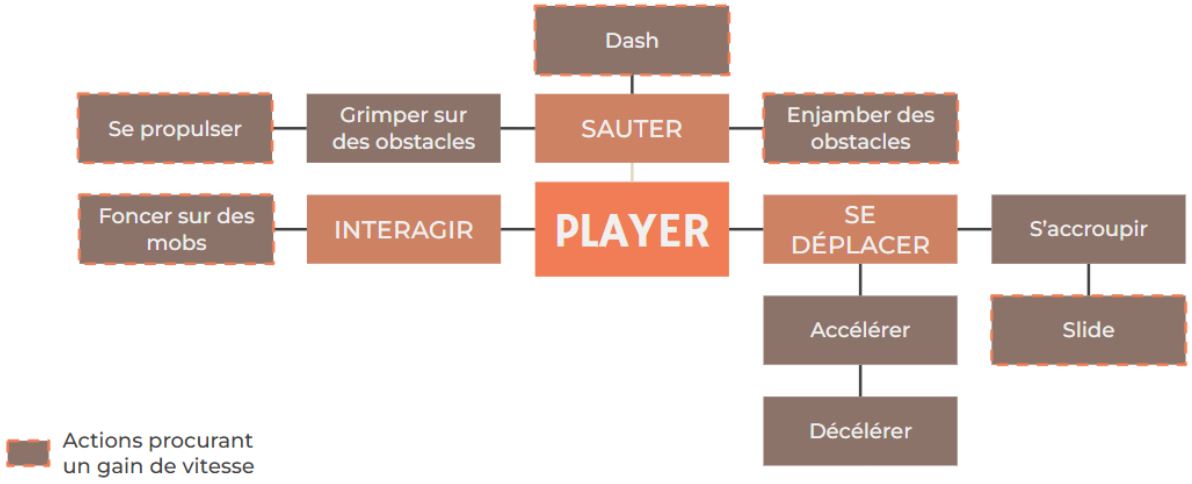
Nyss does not fight with her bare hands in a conventional way. She breaks obstacles with her own body. By exploiting her extreme speed and feline agility, she creates a powerful impact on a frontal collision. She does not destroy walls out of rage, but out of necessity: she optimizes her passage. By propelling her legs forward at full speed, the shockwave directly pulverizes the obstacle in front of her.

The Universe: Luulla and the Forgotten Worlds

The game takes place across several thematic environments corresponding to the various civilizations erased by The Hand. Each level represents a world swallowed by oblivion: cities of fire, cities of ice, levitating ruins. These settings are both beautiful and hostile, reflecting the suppressed history of these peoples.

- Fire World: Lava lakes, charred structures, igneous creatures.
- Cold World: Ice platforms, violent winds, crystalline architecture.
- Erased Archives: Corridors of corrupted data, spaces that rewrite themselves in real time.

VII. 3C - CAMERA, CONTROLS, CHARACTER



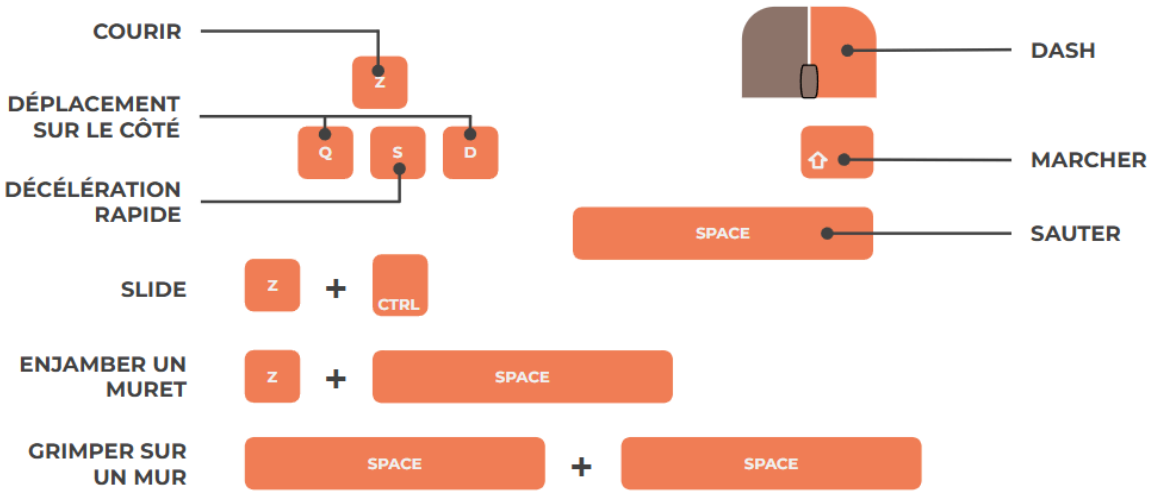
Camera

- First-person view (FP)
- Dynamic camera shake on impacts and falls
- Dynamic FOV: increases proportionally with speed
- Motion blur activated during boost and dash phases
- Slight camera oscillation during running (head bobbing)

Keyboard / Mouse Controls

Key	Action
W (or Z)	Run; slight friction until stop when released
A / D (Q / D)	Lateral movement (strafe)
S	Quick deceleration (handbrake style) / Move backward when stopped
SPACE	Jump
CTRL + W (or SHIFT)	Slide
Slide + SPACE (good timing)	Speed boost
SPACE + SHIFT + light obstacle	Vault (over a low barrier)
Vault (good timing)	Speed boost
SPACE + accessible ledge	Vault (climb over a wall)
Vault + SPACE (good timing)	Propelled high jump

LEFT CLICK	Aerial dash (once only in the air)
Dash into a mob	Kill enemy + dash reset + boost
R	Immediate level restart



Character - Movement Abilities

Running

Nyss's running speed is above average. She accelerates progressively to give a sense of building momentum. Releasing the key causes a slight deceleration due to friction, not an abrupt stop.

Slide

Allows passing under obstacles and accelerating on flat surfaces. Combined with a jump at the right moment, the slide generates an additional speed boost.

Aerial Dash

A directional dash usable only once in the air. It automatically recharges upon touching the ground or hitting an enemy. This is the key mechanic for crossing large gaps or reaching distant platforms.

Wall Destruction

Certain walls (visually marked) can be destroyed if Nyss hits them at sufficient speed. The required speed is adjustable based on the wall's resistance.

VIII. MECHANICS & DETAILED SYSTEMS

1. Basic Movement Behavior

Nyss moves continuously as long as the directional key is held. Acceleration is progressive: she does not instantly reach her maximum speed.

Phase	Description
Start (0 to 30%)	Slight inertia delay simulating body weight - 0 to ~5 m/s in ~0.3 s.
Ramp-up (30% to 100%)	Linear acceleration up to base speed of 15 m/s in ~0.8 s.
Constant speed	Nyss maintains 15 m/s as long as the key is held with no obstacle.
Release	Gentle friction: deceleration of -0.2 m/s per frame until full stop. No abrupt blocking.
Lateral movement	A/D allow strafing at 60% of forward speed. No pivot animation.

- Direction can be changed at any time without interrupting movement.
- Lateral movement does not hurt forward speed: both axes are added (normalized vector).
- No delay between input and movement start; responsiveness is prioritized over realism.

2. Boost System Behavior

The boost is a temporary speed gain triggered by a well-executed action (slide + jump, vault, perfect landing...). It is not a resource; it is a reward.

Parameter	Value / Behavior
Maximum boosted speed	30 m/s (x2 base speed)
Boost duration	Short (0.5 to 1 s depending on triggering action), then gradual return to 15 m/s
Boost stacking	Possible: chaining two boosting actions extends total duration
Boost during slide	Boost applies at slide exit, not during
Boost during dash	Dash preserves current velocity and adds its own directional momentum
Landing boost	Perfect Landing (input at the right timing) triggers a short forward boost

- The boost is strictly visual and kinesthetic: FOV widens, motion blur, screen aura.
- No gauge indicator on screen; the player feels the boost rather than managing it as a resource.
- A boost interrupted by a collision (wall, edge) is immediately canceled with no additional penalty.

3. Continuous Deceleration Behavior

Pressing S from any movement state triggers rapid deceleration, a kind of 'handbrake'. It is not an instant stop but a strong slowdown.

Context	Behavior
Normal running	Deceleration of -1.5 m/s per frame then full stop in ~0.5 s.
At full speed (15 m/s)	Same rate, stop time ~1 s.
Post-boost (30 m/s)	Deceleration of -2 m/s per frame then return to 15 m/s in ~0.4 s, then normal stop.
At full stop	Holding S triggers backward walking (2 m/s max, same friction on release).
During slide	S cancels the slide and decelerates immediately, useful for precise stopping.

- Deceleration is a mechanic: it is used to position precisely before a jump or vault.
- It does not cancel an ongoing dash.
- Distinct sound feedback (intense friction) to signal the braking state to the player.

4. Jump Behavior

The jump is one of the most fundamental mechanics. It must be precise, readable, and offer directional freedom.

Parameter	Value / Behavior
Jump height	Approximately 2.5 units (adjustable based on LD scale)
Speed preservation	Horizontal speed at jump time is fully preserved in the air
Aerial control	Player can steer Nyss +/-30 degrees from trajectory in flight without any blocking
Coyote time	200 ms: player can briefly jump after leaving a platform

Jump buffering	150 ms: if SPACE is pressed just before landing, jump triggers on landing
Jump against a wall	Nyss slightly bounces: no native wall-jump, but planned via vault

- Coyote time and jump buffering are invisible to the player but essential: they make jumps more forgiving and prevent frustration.
- In the air, gravity is slightly increased at the apex for a cleaner, more readable arc.
- A short jump (quick release of SPACE) gives a lower jump than a held jump.

5. Score System Behavior

The score is entirely diegetic via the color of the Chrono-Ore. No numbers are displayed during gameplay: the player 'sees' their performance in the object they hold.

Color	Meaning / Rank
Bright blue (spawn)	Chrono fully charged - perfect performance if maintained at exit
Cyan	Slight degradation - good run, rank A
Green	Moderate degradation - rank B
Yellow	Notable degradation - rank C
Orange	Slow run - rank D
Red	Chrono nearly depleted - rank E / F

- Color degrades in real time, continuously and fluidly (color lerp). No abrupt thresholds.
- The final color when Nyss crosses the exit is captured and displayed in the level selection menu.
- On death and restart, the color resets to zero (blue). Score only counts a complete, successful run.
- Each level has its own time thresholds (X values to be defined by LD).

6. Slide Behavior

The slide is a 'low-height' movement state triggered by CTRL + W (or SHIFT). It allows passing under obstacles, accelerating on slopes, and combining with other moves.

Parameter	Value / Behavior
Trigger condition	Nyss must be running (> 5 m/s) to initiate a slide
Speed at trigger	Inherited from entry speed; the slide does not generate speed on its own

Max duration on flat surface	1 second, then Nyss automatically stands up
On downward slope	Duration is infinite as long as slope >= 10 degrees. Speed increases by 2 m/s per second
Hitbox height	Reduced by ~50% (allows passing under obstacles ~1 unit high)
Cancellation	Releasing CTRL or pressing SPACE ends the slide immediately
Slide + jump (good timing)	Within 200 ms before natural slide end: +8 m/s boost and high jump

- A slide launched from a boost preserves the boosted speed for the entire slide duration.
- Slide cannot be immediately re-triggered after it ends: 0.3 s cooldown to prevent spamming.
- Visual feedback: ground trail, particles based on material (stone, ice, metal).

7. Dash Behavior

The dash is an instant directional movement usable only once in the air (LEFT CLICK). It is the central aerial mechanic, allowing gap-crossing, enemy elimination, and combo chaining.

Parameter	Value / Behavior
Distance	3 meters in the direction of gaze / movement
Animation duration	Very short (~0.15 s) and near-instant, reinforces power sensation
Direction	Based on gaze direction (camera) + player directional input
Recharge (ground)	~2 s cooldown once Nyss touches any flat surface
Recharge (mob)	Immediate if dash hits an enemy. Reset + boost
Preserved velocity	Pre-dash horizontal speed is added to the dash, not replaced

- Only one dash available at a time. No double-dash without reset.
- During the dash, Nyss is briefly invulnerable to environmental damage (not to mob contact without dashing).
- Feedback: silhouette trail, whoosh + impact sound, slight FOV distortion.

8. Wall Destruction System Behavior

Destructible walls are obstacles that Nyss can break by hitting them at sufficient speed. They are visually identifiable (cracked texture, orange color) and constitute shortcuts or speed puzzles.

Wall Type	Required Speed	Behavior on Impact
Fragile wall (tutorial)	5 m/s (fast walk)	Breaks immediately, no speed loss
Standard wall	12 m/s (sustained running)	Broken, slight deceleration of -2 m/s
Reinforced wall	25 m/s (boost required)	Broken, deceleration of -5 m/s, strong shock effect
Resistant wall	Indestructible	Nyss bounces, total speed loss, 0.2 s stun

- If speed is insufficient: no wall damage, slight Nyss deceleration (-1 m/s), dull sound feedback.
- Destruction produces physical debris (VFX only, no gameplay) and a strong impact sound.
- Destroyed walls do not regenerate in the same session; they remain open until restart.
- A wall destroyed in a previous run stays destroyed if the player retries without a full reload (to confirm with LD).

9. Vault-Over System Behavior

The vault-over (SPACE + SHIFT + light obstacle ahead) allows Nyss to clear low obstacles without going around them or stopping. It is a fluidity mechanic that preserves speed.

Parameter	Value / Behavior
Max obstacle height	~1 unit (barriers, ledges, low crates)
Required approach speed	>= 8 m/s; vault-over is impossible at low speed
Animation	Nyss places a hand on the obstacle and passes over in ~0.3 s
Speed preservation	90% of entry speed is preserved at exit
Vault-over + good timing	SPACE input within 100 ms at the top of the vault: +6 m/s boost
Failed vault-over (too slow)	Nyss hits the obstacle, -3 m/s deceleration, no jump

- Perfect timing is indicated by a brief flash on Nyss's hand (FPS visual feedback).
- The vault-over can chain directly into an aerial dash at its exit.
- It cannot be triggered intentionally; it is an automatic low-obstacle proximity detection.

10. Vault / Wall Climb Behavior

The vault (SPACE + accessible ledge) allows Nyss to climb over walls or ledges higher than a vault-over. It is a vertical movement mechanic.

Parameter	Value / Behavior
Ledge height	Between 1 and 2.5 units (beyond that, inaccessible)
Trigger	SPACE within 0.5 m of a ledge
Animation	Nyss grabs the ledge with her hands, pulls herself up in ~0.5 s
Speed at exit	5 m/s forward; vault resets momentum from zero
Vault + jump (good timing)	SPACE within 150 ms after vault exit: propulsion to 15 m/s + doubled jump height
Vault from dash	A dash toward a wall + vault triggers a big propelled jump automatically with good timing

- The vault is slower than the vault-over but reserved for high obstacles that cannot be bypassed or for shortcuts.
- Main climbable ledges are subtly indicated (slight highlight on the edge) to guide the player without HUD.
- A failed vault (SPACE not pressed in time) bounces Nyss off the wall and causes total speed loss.

11. Walking Behavior

Walking is the default movement state, without a key pressed or with SHIFT held alone. It exists primarily for slow exploration and precise positioning; it is not the normal gameplay state.

Parameter	Value / Behavior
Walking speed	3 m/s, approximately 1/5 of running speed
Trigger	SHIFT alone held during running (toggle walk), or when speed naturally drops below 3 m/s
Run to walk transition	Immediate if SHIFT is pressed. By friction if run key is released.
Jump from walking	Possible but height reduced by 20%; body is not in momentum

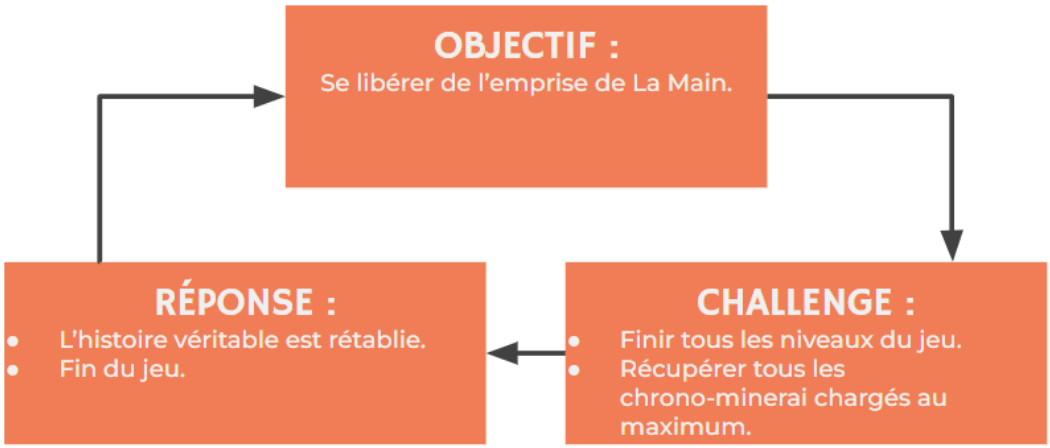
Slide from walking	Impossible; speed is insufficient to trigger the slide
Main use	Precise positioning on a ledge before a vault or calibrated jump

- Walking has no competitive use case. An expert player never walks.
- Retained for novice players who explore or for puzzle zones requiring precision.
- No head bobbing animation during walking, only during running.

IX. GAMEPLAY LOOPS

Macro Loop - Global Objective

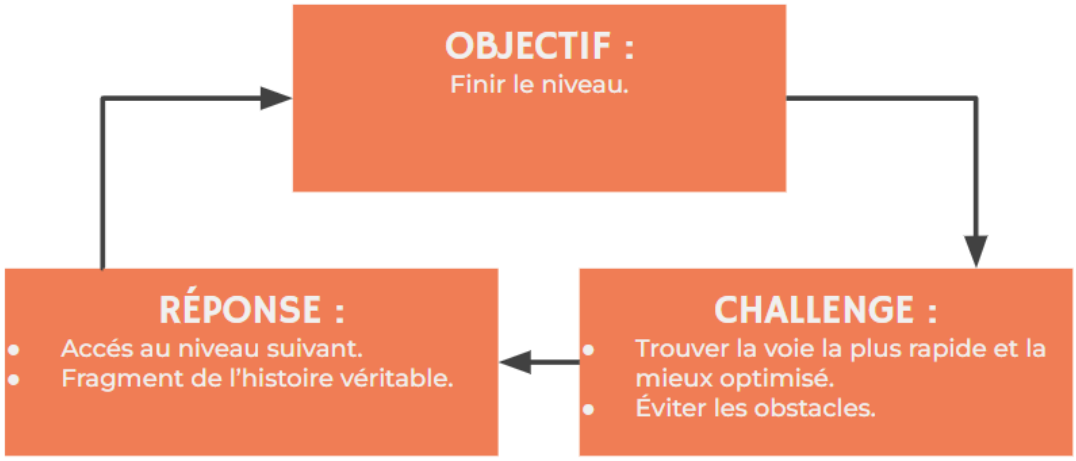
Objective: Break free from the grip of The Hand.



Challenge	Response
Complete all levels in the game.	The true history is restored.
Recover all Chrono-Ore at maximum charge.	Game complete - total victory.

Mid Loop - Per Level Objective

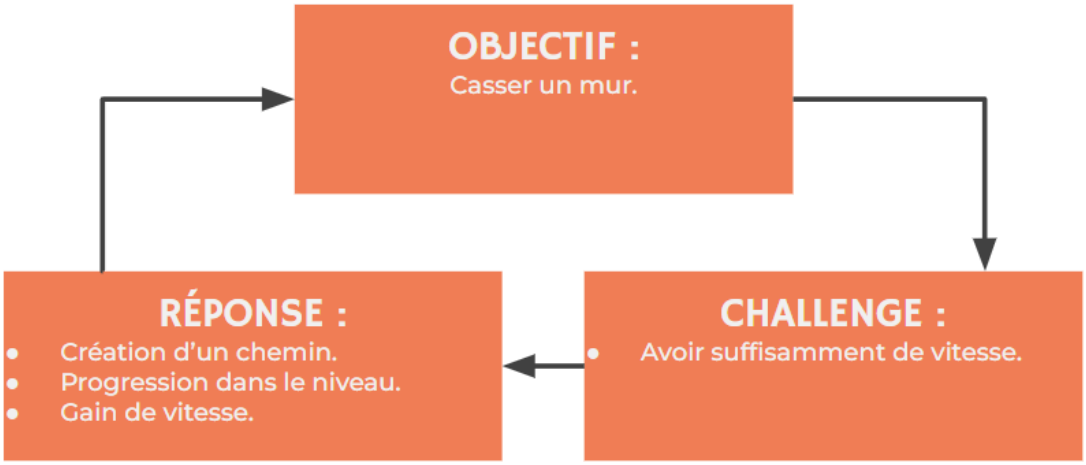
Objective: Complete the level.

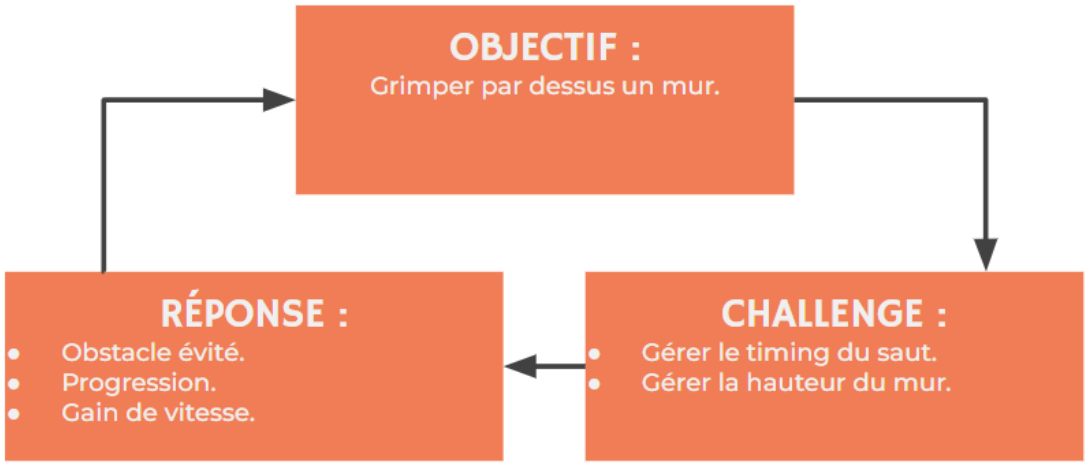


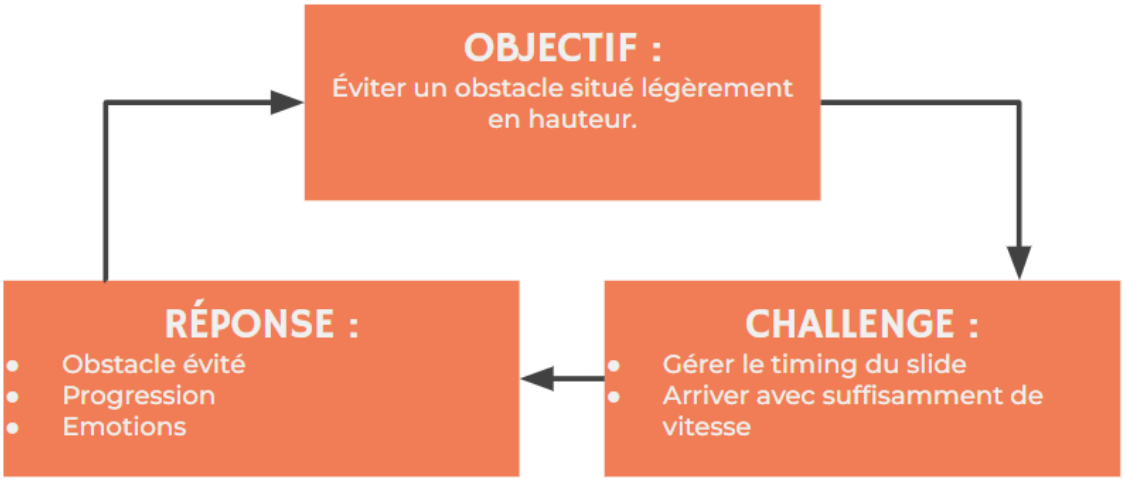
Challenge	Response
Find the fastest and most optimized route.	Access to the next level.
Avoid obstacles and enemies.	Fragment of true history unlocked.

Micro Loop - In-Level Actions

Three types of interactions define the micro loop:







Objective	Challenge	Response
Break a wall	Have enough speed	New path created + progression + speed gain
Climb over a wall	Manage jump timing / wall height	Obstacle cleared + progression + speed gain
Avoid a high obstacle	Manage slide timing + arrive with enough speed	Obstacle avoided + progression + emotions

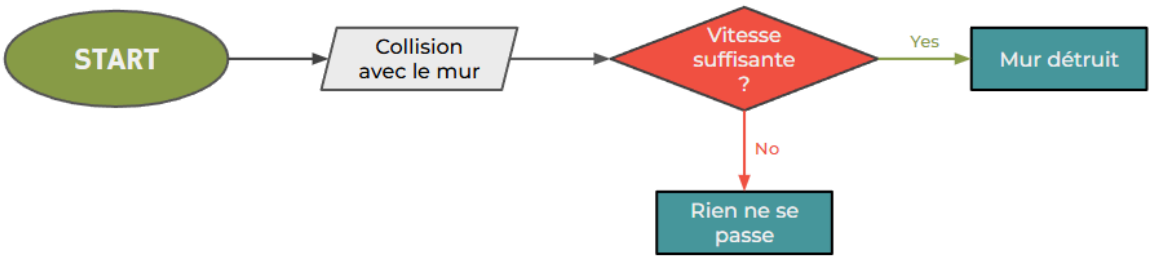
Loop Philosophy

Every action in Ascend Rush follows a simple principle: reward precision and fluidity. Missing an action slows the player but does not punish irremediably. Executing a chain of actions well generates momentum that encourages going ever faster.

X. IN-GAME INTERACTIONS

Destructible Walls

Destructible walls are marked by a specific texture or color (e.g., cracked orange). They only break if Nyss hits them at a minimum configurable speed.



Condition	Result
Collision at sufficient speed	Wall destroyed - path opened - speed gain
Collision at insufficient speed	Nothing happens - slight deceleration

Spawn & Artifact

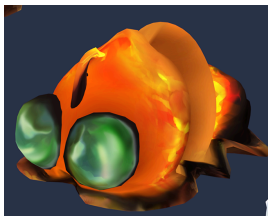
Spawn

The player appears at the start of the level with the Chrono-Ore in hand. This artifact is simultaneously the objective, score, and diegetic timer.

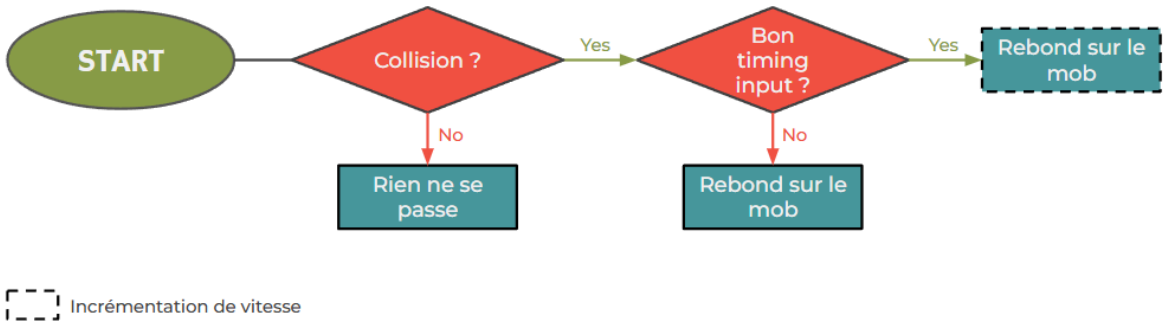
The Artifact: Chrono-Ore

The Chrono-Ore is the player's diegetic timer. Its material progressively shifts from intense blue (maximum speed) to red (time largely exceeded), passing through several intermediate hues. At the end of the level, the color of the artifact constitutes the score visible in level selection - no abstract numbers, everything is integrated into the universe.

The Larva



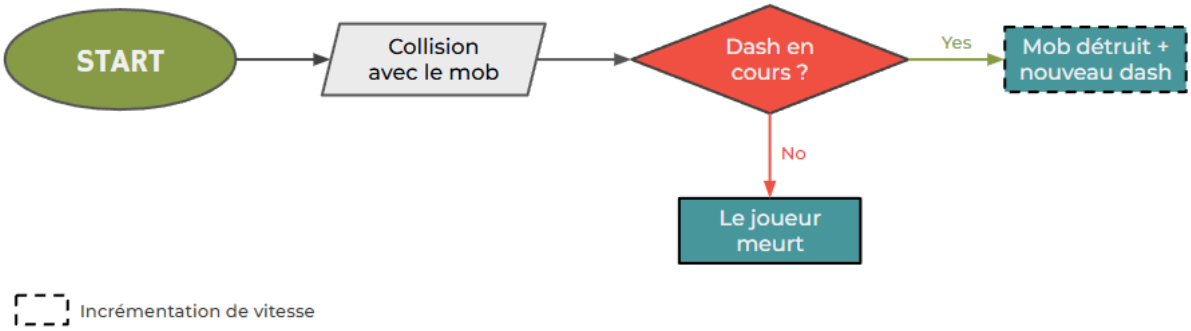
Larvae live in lava lakes and move slowly. Their sticky surface allows Nyss to bounce off them. By jumping on them with good timing, the player gets a propelled bounce and speed boost.



Condition	Result
Collision without specific timing	Standard bounce on the larva
Collision + good input timing	Amplified bounce + speed gain

The Bats

These creatures live in flame zones and generally move in a straight line. Their predictable behavior makes them mobile springboards for the player. By dashing into them, Nyss eliminates them and resets her aerial dash while gaining a boost.



Condition	Result

Dashing during collision	Mob destroyed + new dash available + boost
Collision without dash	Nyss dies - level restart

XI. GAMEFLOW

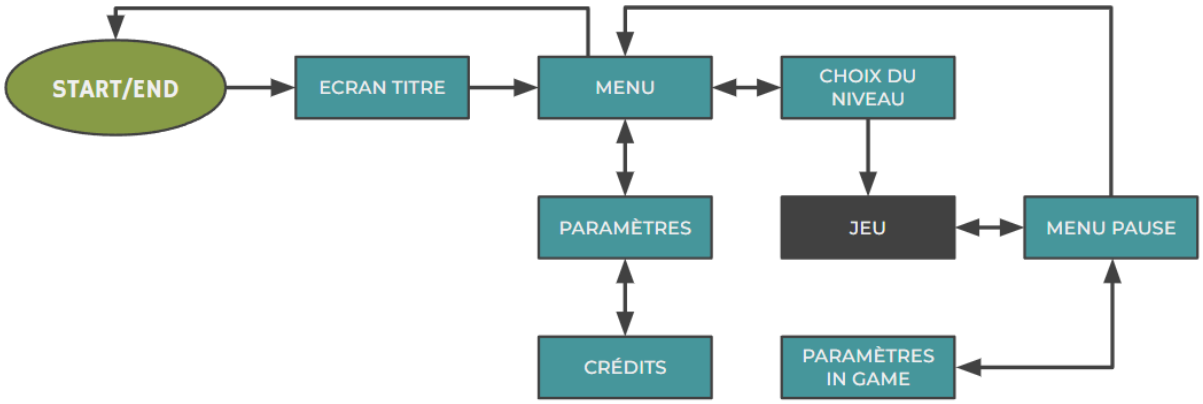
Menu Navigation

Main navigation flow of the game (version of 12/02/2025):

Screen	Possible Transitions
Title Screen	Main Menu
Main Menu	Level Select / Settings / Credits
Level Select	Main Menu / Game
Game	Pause Menu / In-game Settings
Pause Menu	Game / In-game Settings / Main Menu
End of Level	Next Level Select / Retry / Menu

Level Structure

- The player spawns with the Chrono-Ore in hand. The diegetic timer starts immediately.
- They traverse the level by chaining acrobatics to optimize their route.
- Various obstacle types line the course: destructible walls, enemies, jump zones.
- Upon reaching the exit, the level ends. The artifact's final color constitutes the score.
- A results screen displays time, performance rank (artifact color), and personal best.



XII. WIREFRAMES

Main Screens

Screen	Key Elements
Title Screen	Centered Ascend Rush logo, Nyss animation in background, 'Press to Start' prompt
Main Menu	4 options: Play, Settings, Credits, Quit - keyboard or mouse navigation
Level Select	Level grid with thumbnail, artifact color (best score), locked/unlocked status
In-Game Pause	Semi-transparent overlay: Resume, Restart, Settings, Main Menu
End of Level	Large artifact + color, achieved time, best time, Retry or Next option

In-Game HUD

Ascend Rush's HUD is intentionally minimalist to maximize immersion:

- Chrono-Ore in hand (visible at bottom of screen): the color is the diegetic timer.
- Speed indicator: subtle visual aura around the screen whose intensity varies with speed.
- Dash available indicator: discreet icon at bottom right (full = available, empty = recharging).
- No numeric timer on screen; the artifact's color is sufficient.

XIII. LEVEL DESIGN

Level Design Principles

- Readability: The optimal path must be visible without being obvious. The player should identify it through observation.
- Progression: Early levels introduce one mechanic at a time. Advanced levels combine them.
- Multiple routes: Each level has at least two paths: one safe and slow, one risky and fast.
- Pacing: Alternate between frantic acceleration phases and moments of precision to avoid saturation.
- Narrative environment: Sets tell a story without dialogue: ruins, scattered artifacts, remnants.

Typical Level Structure Example

Phase	Description
Introduction	More open area, simple obstacles, learning the environmental context
Ramp-up	Chaining mechanics seen in tutorial & FTUE, pace accelerates
Difficulty peak	Demanding sequence requiring mastery and timing - high satisfaction if completed
Finale	Chained dash and boost zone toward the exit - maximum speed sensation

Planned Levels - Vertical Slice

Level	Theme	Introduced Mechanic
Level 0 - Tutorial	Erased Archives (clean white)	Running, slide, jump, artifact
Level 1 - Brazier	Fire World (lava, charred structures)	Destructible walls, larvae, bats
Level 2 - Crystal	Cold World (ice, wind)	Slippery surfaces, long aerial dash, vaults
Level 3 - Archives	Data corridors (unstable environment)	Dynamic obstacles, advanced timing, combos

XIV. CINEMATICS

Intro Cinematic

The intro cinematic presents the universe and Nyss without explanatory dialogue. It works through images and sensations:

- Wide shot of a ravaged world - ruins of a city, red sky.
- Zoom on a pulsing Chrono-Ore fragment. Fleeting images of true History are reflected in it as flashbacks.
- Nyss grabs the fragment. Her gaze is determined. She runs.
- Title: ASCEND RUSH - cut to gameplay.

Inter-Level Cinematics

Short sequences of 15 to 30 seconds separate the worlds. They show Nyss in motion, Chrono-Ore fragments reassembling, and flashes of restored History. These sequences can be skipped.

Ending Cinematic

When Nyss recovers the last fragment, a final sequence shows The Hand progressively collapsing in the face of truth restoration. Nyss watches the worlds rebuild. No speech, just images, music, and the ore returning to brilliant blue. The final shot being the ore, a calm blue, like the world.

XV. SOUND DESIGN

Sound Direction

The music and sounds of Ascend Rush reinforce the sensation of speed and immersion in a hostile yet living universe. The sonic identity rests on three pillars:

- Urgency: Fast rhythms (120-160 BPM) for intense running phases.
- Mystery: Atmospheric pads in menus and cinematics to emphasize the universe.
- Satisfaction: Clear, rewarding validation sounds for every well-executed action.

Gameplay SFX

Action	Expected Sound
Normal running	Sole friction, light breathing
Slide	Intense friction, sliding sound based on surface material
Aerial dash	Brief powerful whoosh + light air impact
Wall destruction	Dull impact and debris explosion
Boost (max speed)	Continuous rumble, slight sonic distortion
Chrono-Ore collection	Unique crystalline sound, memorable
Death / Restart	Brief silence + 'temporal rewind' sound

Music

- Main menu: Slow, mysterious electronic atmosphere with crystalline mineral notes.
- Standard levels: Electronic / Industrial with progressive intensity increase based on player speed.
- Advanced levels: Intense rhythmic breaks, heavy percussion.
- Cinematics: Minimalist orchestral with a recurring motif tied to the Chrono-Ore.

XVI. FIRST TIME USER EXPERIENCE (FTUE)

FTUE Objective

The player must understand the basic mechanics and feel gameplay satisfaction in under 5 minutes, without ever reading a long explanatory text.

Onboarding Sequence

Step	Method
1. Launch	Short cinematic that contextualizes the emotional stakes before gameplay
2. First movement	Directed corridor, only the 'run' key works - learning by action
3. First obstacle	Low wall - visual jump indicator, no text
4. First destructible wall	Speed already acquired; the game 'pushes' the player toward the wall - natural discovery
5. First artifact	Spawned with artifact in hand - very visible blue color, immediate intuition

FTUE Principles

- Show, don't tell: Visual cues (colors, lights, level design) guide without text.
- No possible death in the first 30 seconds: the player must have fun first.
- The first level is a tutorial disguised as a real level (reference: World 1-1 from Super Mario Bros. NES).

XVII. TUTORIALS

Level 0 - Tutorial: Initiation

The intent is to force the player to learn basic movement mechanics (running, walking), level design destruction (breaking walls), the objective (recovering the artifact), and the associated timer.

- Simple gameplay situations are presented progressively.
- The artifact is placed behind several walls: the player must break them to access it.
- Once the artifact is picked up, a beacon indicates the direction of the spawn/exit.
- No tutorial text displayed on screen: everything is communicated through level construction.

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Mechanics Introduced by Level

Level	Taught Mechanic
Tutorial (Lvl. 0)	Running, jump, destructible walls, artifact, exit
Level 1	Slide, boost, larvae (bounce), bats (dash)
Level 2	Aerial dash, vault, slippery surfaces

Level 3	Movement combos, dynamic obstacles, route optimization

XVIII. GAME USE

Typical Play Sessions

Player Profile	Session Duration	Expected Behavior
Casual player	15-30 min	Completes levels at their own pace, explores the universe
Speedrunner	1h+	Optimizes every run, retries to beat their record
Completionist	30-45 min	Seeks to get the blue artifact (perfect score) on each level

Retention Metrics

- Short-term: Immediate satisfaction on every well-executed action - sound, animation, visual feedback.
- Mid-term: Progression through levels and visible score improvement (artifact color).
- Long-term: Personal leaderboards, replay value of route optimization, additional worlds.

XIX. TUNING & BALANCING

Speed Variables

Variable	Target Value	Notes
Base running speed	15 m/s	Must feel 'fast' from the start
Maximum speed (boost)	30 m/s	Approximately 2x base speed
Friction deceleration	-0.2 m/s down to a minimum of 15 m/s	Gentle: never abruptly block
Slide duration	As long as on a slope, otherwise 1 s	Long enough to be useful, not too long to prevent abuse
Dash distance	3 m	Must allow crossing the visual gaps of the LD, preserves velocity

Wall Destruction Variables

Wall Type	Required Speed	Resistance
Fragile wall (tutorial)	Low	Accessible from the start of the game
Standard wall	Medium	Requires a sustained running phase
Reinforced wall	High	Requires a boost or speed combo

Score System / Diegetic Timer

Artifact Color	Rank	Condition
Bright blue	S - Perfect	Finish in less than X seconds (per level)
Cyan	A - Excellent	Between X and X+15 seconds
Green	B - Good	Between X+15 and X+30 seconds

Yellow	C - Average	Between X+30 and X+60 seconds
Red	D - Slow	More than X+60 seconds

XX. VIDEO

Planned Trailers

- Announcement Trailer: Cinematic + gameplay, highlights speed and universe. Duration: 90 sec.
- Gameplay Trailer: Pure gameplay, no cuts, shows fluid movement and combos. Duration: 60 sec.
- GIFs / Short clips: For social media, dash, wall destruction, larva bounce.

Press Screenshots

- FP view at full speed in the Fire World.
- Dash on a bat with visual trail.
- Bright blue artifact in hand - close-up shot.
- Overview of a level - grandiose architecture.

XXI. CREDITS

Team

Role	Members
Game Design	Zimmermann Nicolas, Wu Anthony
Tech Artist	Camier Evan, Benzaquen Nathan, Fort Antonis Vitaro-Giardi, Olmo
Game Artist	Turk Adriel, Hempel Killian, Marty Eugene Augustin, Wu Sophie, Saadati Kamand, Ait Shaines

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